

Software Processes

LECTURE 1

Objectives

- ▶ The objective of this chapter is to introduce you to the idea of a software process – a coherent set of activities for software production. You will :
 - ▶ Understand the **concepts of software processes** and software process model;
 - ▶ Have been introduced to **three generic software models** and when they might be used;
 - ▶ Know about the **fundamental process activities** of software requirements engineering, software development, testing and evolution;
 - ▶ Understand why processes **should be organized** to cope with **changes** in the software requirements and design.

Topics covered

- ▶ Software process models
- ▶ Process activities
- ▶ Coping with change

The software process

- ▶ A structured set of activities required to develop a software system.
- ▶ Many different software processes but all involve:
 - ▶ **Specification** – defining what the system should do;
 - ▶ **Design and implementation** – defining the organization of the system and implementing the system;
 - ▶ **Validation** – checking that it does what the customer wants;
 - ▶ **Evolution** – changing the system in response to changing customer needs.
- ▶ A software process model is an abstract representation of a process. It presents a description of a process from some particular perspective.

- ▶ Share your experience develop any system/apps/web system etc.
- ▶ How you manage/plan?
- ▶ Did you follow any process , method?
- ▶ Challenge, impediments?

Software process descriptions

- ▶ When we describe and discuss processes, we usually talk about the **activities in these processes** such as specifying a data model, designing a user interface, etc. and the ordering of these activities.
- ▶ Process descriptions may also include:
 - ▶ **Products**, which are the outcomes of a process activity;
 - ▶ **Roles**, which reflect the responsibilities of the people involved in the process;
 - ▶ **Pre- and post-conditions**, which are statements that are true before and after a process activity has been enacted or a product produced.

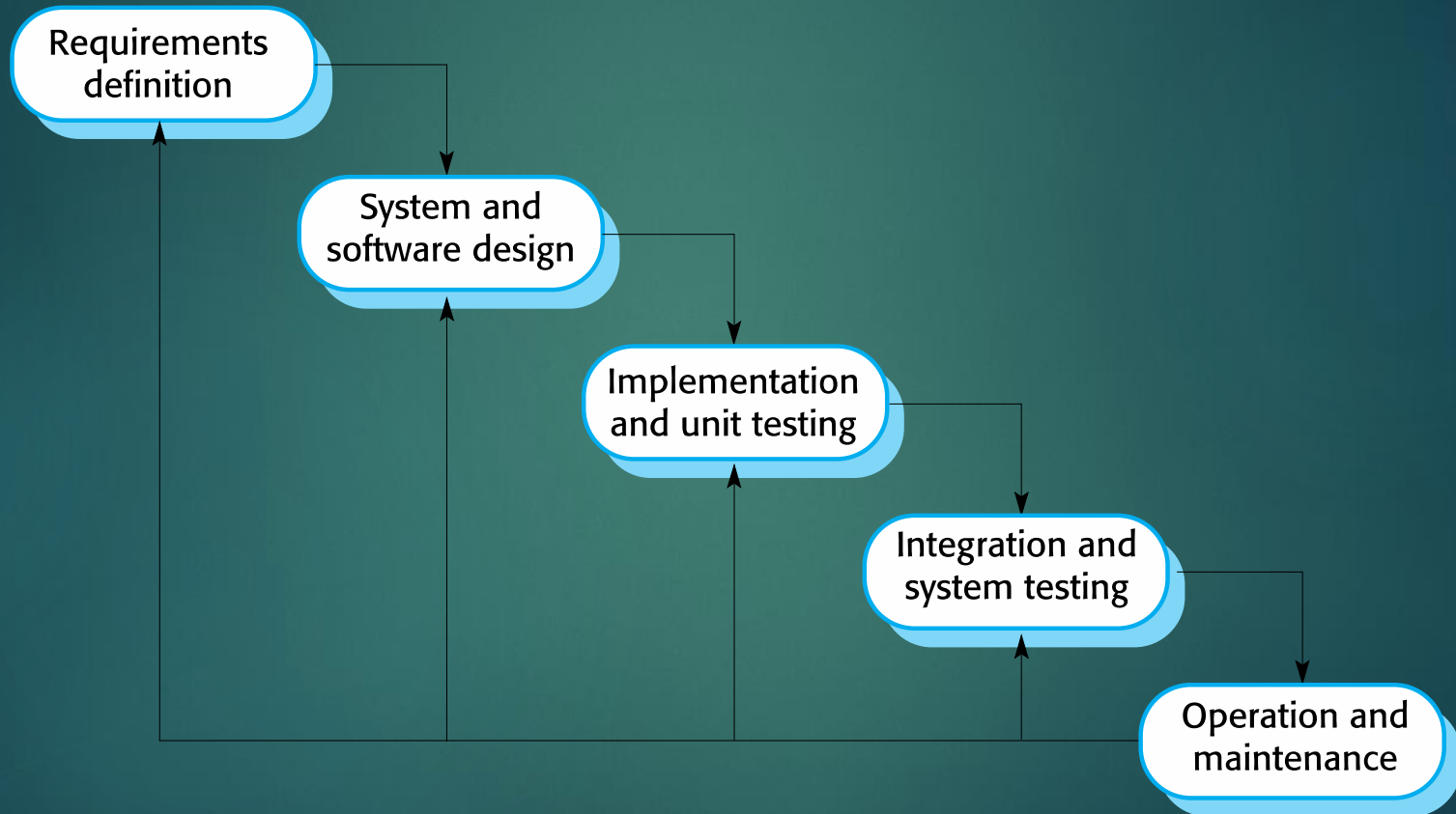
Plan-driven and agile processes

- ▶ **Plan-driven** processes are processes where all of the **process activities are planned in advance** and progress is measured against this plan.
- ▶ In agile processes, **planning is incremental** and it is **easier to change the process** to reflect changing customer requirements.
- ▶ **In practice**, most practical processes include elements **of both** plan-driven and agile approaches.
- ▶ There are no right or wrong software processes.

Software process models

- ▶ **The waterfall model**
 - ▶ Plan-driven model. Separate and distinct phases of specification and development.
- ▶ **Incremental development**
 - ▶ Specification, development and validation are interleaved. May be plan-driven or agile.
- ▶ **Reuse-oriented software engineering**
 - ▶ The system is assembled from existing components. May be plan-driven or agile.
- ▶ In practice, most large systems are developed using a process that incorporates elements from all of these models.

The waterfall model



Waterfall model phases

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- ▶ There are separate identified phases in the waterfall model:
 - ▶ Requirements analysis and definition
 - ▶ System and software design
 - ▶ Implementation and unit testing
 - ▶ Integration and system testing
 - ▶ Operation and maintenance
- ▶ The main drawback of the waterfall model is the difficulty of accommodating change after the process is underway. **In principle, a phase has to be complete before moving onto the next phase.**

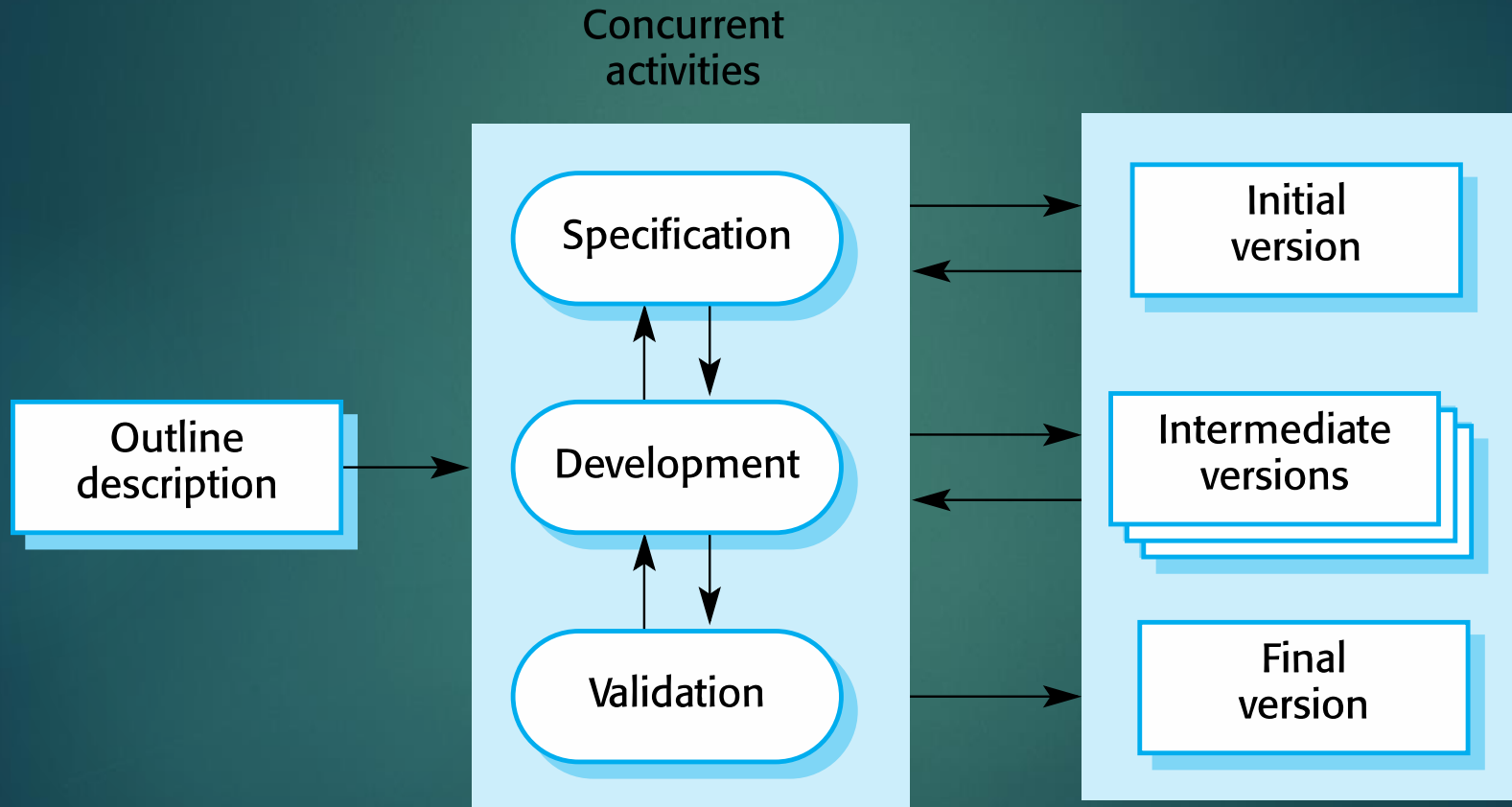
Waterfall model problems

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- ▶ Inflexible partitioning of the project into distinct stages makes it difficult to respond to changing customer requirements.
 - ▶ Therefore, this model is only appropriate when the requirements are well-understood and changes will be fairly limited during the design process.
 - ▶ Few business systems have stable requirements.
- ▶ The waterfall model is mostly used for large systems engineering projects where a system is developed at several sites.
 - ▶ In those circumstances, the plan-driven nature of the waterfall model helps coordinate the work.

Incremental development

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Incremental development benefits

- ▶ The **cost of accommodating changing customer requirements is reduced.**
 - ▶ The amount of analysis and documentation that has to be redone is much less than is required with the waterfall model.
- ▶ It is **easier to get customer feedback** on the development work that has been done.
 - ▶ Customers can comment on demonstrations of the software and see how much has been implemented.
- ▶ More **rapid delivery and deployment of useful software to the customer is possible.**
 - ▶ Customers are able to use and gain value from the software earlier than is possible with a waterfall process.

Incremental development problems

- ▶ The process is not visible.
 - ▶ Managers need regular deliverables to measure progress. If systems are developed quickly, it is not cost-effective to produce documents that reflect every version of the system.
- ▶ System structure tends to degrade as new increments are added.
 - ▶ Unless time and money is spent on refactoring to improve the software, regular change tends to corrupt its structure. Incorporating further software changes becomes increasingly difficult and costly.

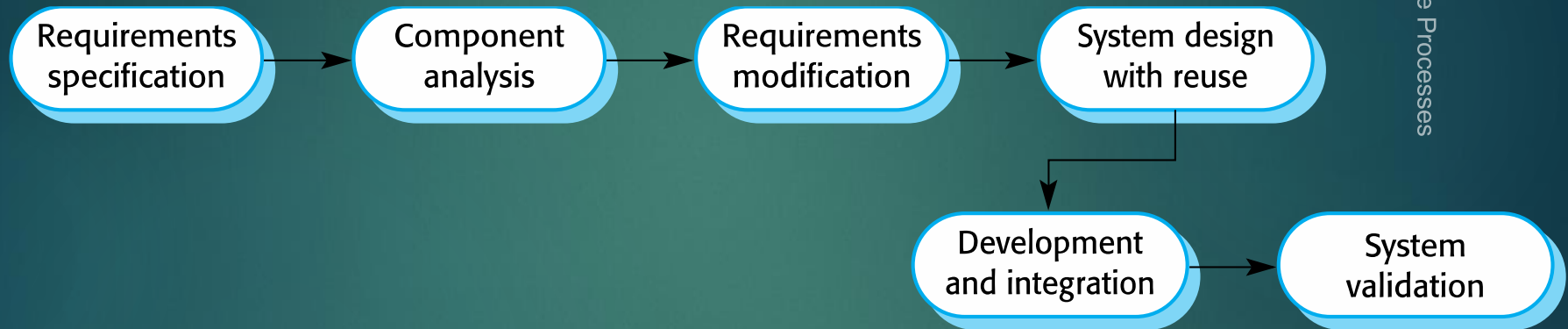
Reuse-oriented software engineering

- ▶ Based on systematic reuse where systems are integrated from existing components or COTS (Commercial-off-the-shelf) systems.
- ▶ Process stages
 - ▶ Component analysis;
 - ▶ Requirements modification;
 - ▶ System design with reuse;
 - ▶ Development and integration.
- ▶ Reuse is now the standard approach for building many types of business system

Reuse-oriented software engineering

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Chapter 2 Software Processes



Process activities

- ▶ Real software processes are inter-leaved sequences of technical, collaborative and managerial activities with the overall goal of specifying, designing, implementing and testing a software system.
- ▶ The four basic process activities of specification, development, validation and evolution are organized differently in different development processes. In the waterfall model, they are organized in sequence, whereas in incremental development they are inter-leaved.

Software specification

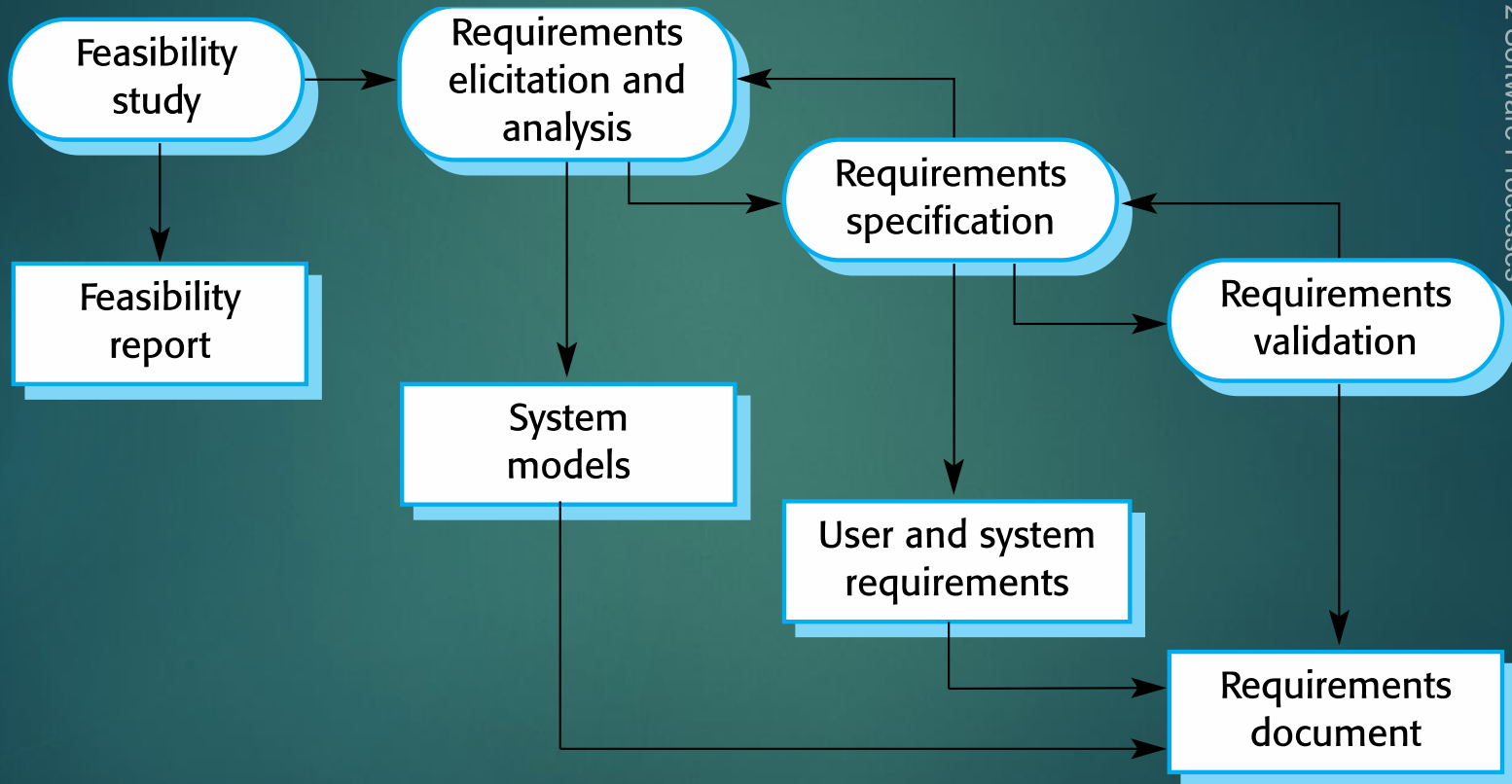
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- ▶ The process of establishing what services are required and the constraints on the system's operation and development.
- ▶ Requirements engineering process
 - ▶ **Feasibility study**
 - ▶ Is it technically and financially feasible to build the system?
 - ▶ **Requirements elicitation and analysis**
 - ▶ What do the system stakeholders require or expect from the system?
 - ▶ **Requirements specification**
 - ▶ Defining the requirements in detail
 - ▶ **Requirements validation**
 - ▶ Checking the validity of the requirements

The requirements engineering process

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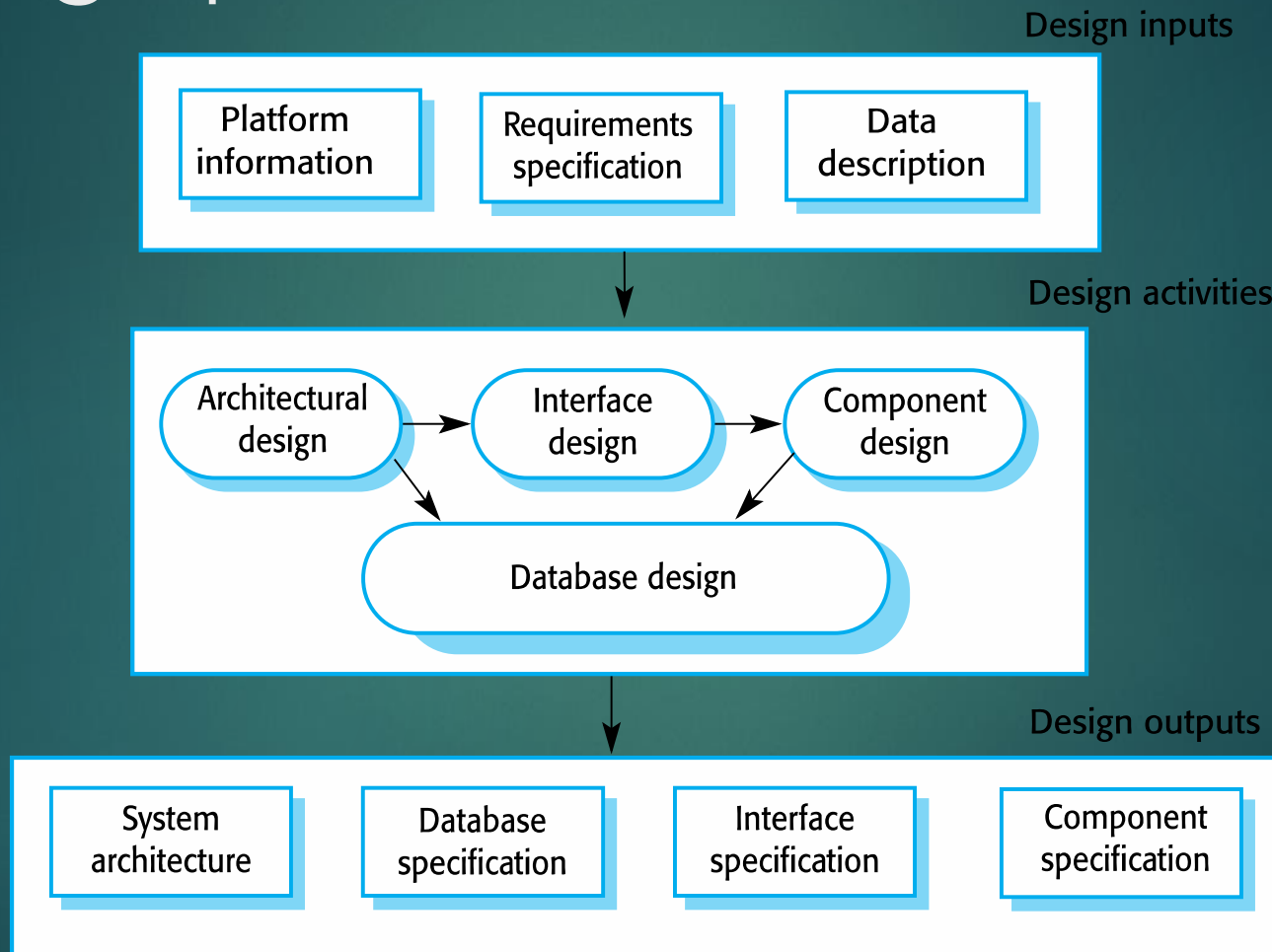


Software design and implementation

- ▶ The process of converting the system specification into an executable system.
- ▶ Software design
 - ▶ Design a software structure that realises the specification;
- ▶ Implementation
 - ▶ Translate this structure into an executable program;
- ▶ The activities of design and implementation are closely related and may be inter-leaved.

A general model of the design process

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Design activities

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- ▶ *Architectural design*, where you identify the overall structure of the system, the principal components (sometimes called sub-systems or modules), their relationships and how they are distributed.
- ▶ *Interface design*, where you define the interfaces between system components.
- ▶ *Component design*, where you take each system component and design how it will operate.
- ▶ *Database design*, where you design the system data structures and how these are to be represented in a database.

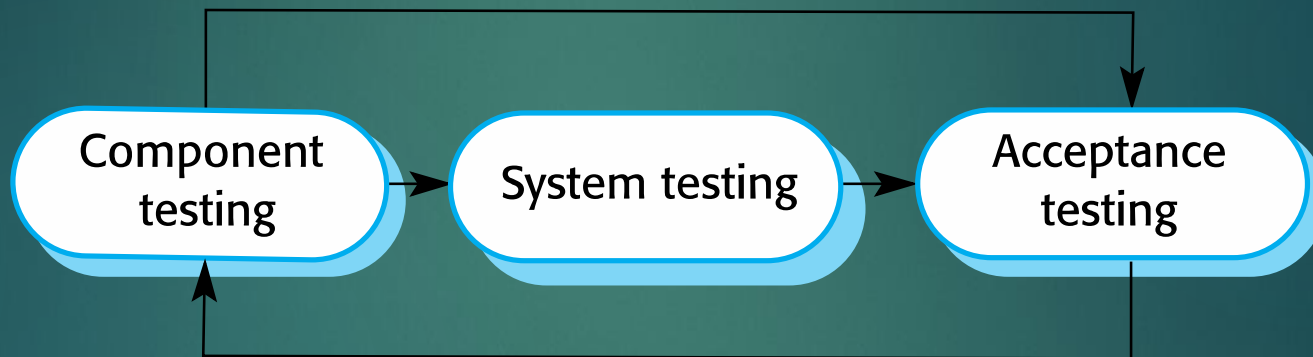
Software validation

- ▶ Verification and validation (V & V) is intended to show that a system conforms to its specification and meets the requirements of the system customer.
- ▶ Involves checking and review processes and system testing.
- ▶ System testing involves executing the system with test cases that are derived from the specification of the real data to be processed by the system.
- ▶ Testing is the most commonly used V & V activity.

Stages of testing

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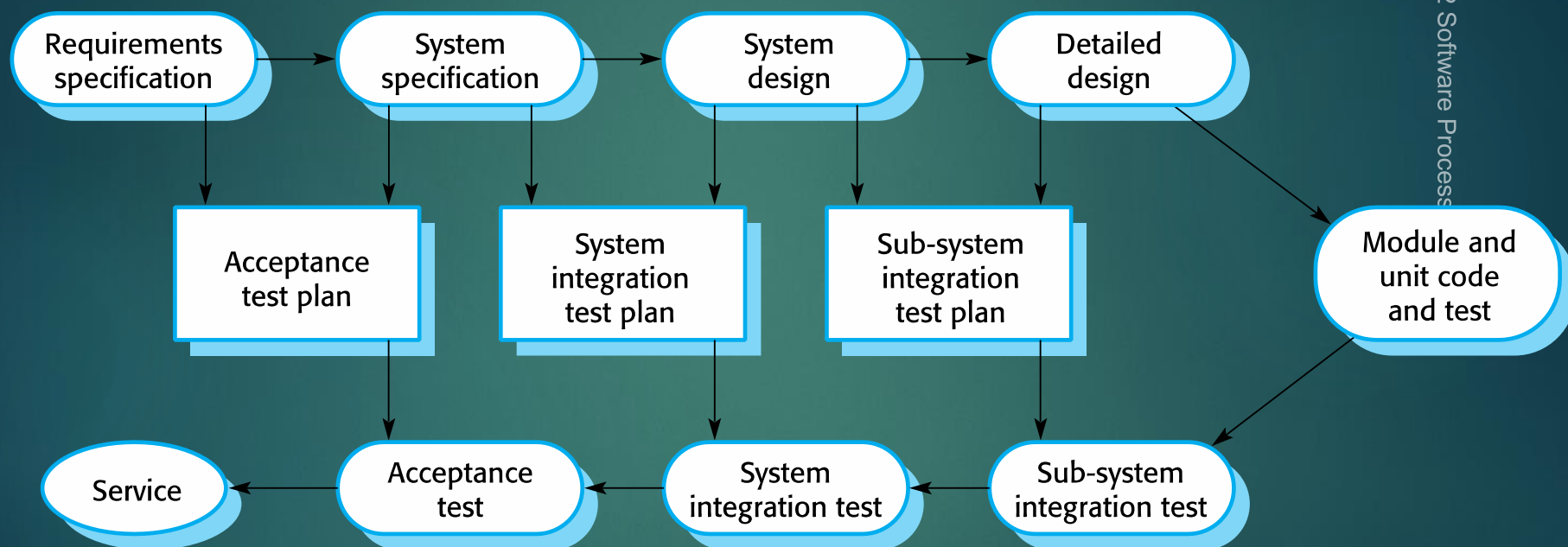


Testing stages

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- ▶ **Development or component testing**
 - ▶ Individual components are tested independently;
 - ▶ Components may be functions or objects or coherent groupings of these entities.
- ▶ **System testing**
 - ▶ Testing of the system as a whole. Testing of emergent properties is particularly important.
- ▶ **Acceptance testing**
 - ▶ Testing with customer data to check that the system meets the customer's needs.

Testing phases in a plan-driven software process



Software evolution

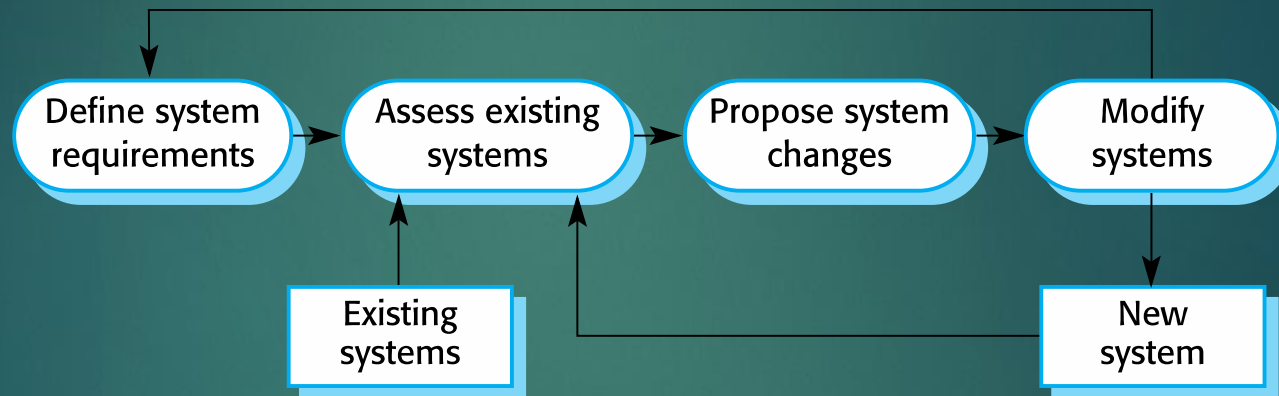
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- ▶ Software is inherently flexible and can change.
- ▶ As requirements change through changing business circumstances, the software that supports the business must also evolve and change.

System evolution

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Chapter 2 Software Processes



Key points

- ▶ Software processes are the activities involved in producing a software system. Software process models are abstract representations of these processes.
- ▶ General process models describe the organization of software processes. Examples of these general models include the 'waterfall' model, incremental development, and reuse-oriented development.

Key points

- ▶ **Requirements engineering** is the process of developing a software specification.
- ▶ **Design and implementation** processes are concerned with transforming a requirements specification into an executable software system.
- ▶ **Software validation** is the process of checking that the system conforms to its specification and that it meets the real needs of the users of the system.
- ▶ **Software evolution** takes place when you change existing software systems to meet new requirements. The software must evolve to remain useful.

Tutorial Week 3

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Tutorial 2

Present your group project development planning by week based on main tasks in the proposed multimedia system by using Tools for Backlog (Part 1)

Example of Tools for Backlog

- ▶ JIRA
- ▶ ClickUP
- ▶ Trello
- ▶ Excel
- ▶ etc

search - tools for backlog management in scrum project

Jira Tutorial for Beginners: Jira Project Management

- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nHuhojfjeUY>

Ultimate Jira Tutorial for Beginners (2025) | Free Agile Project Management Tool

- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8jWKwilcWPI&t=23s>